

StudyBuddy

CW1 Supporting Materials

IN3065 User-Centred System Design 2025–2026

Anker Rasmussen
230022888

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1 Presentation Slide Deck



StudyBuddy

User Research

Research aim



- Support timetabling study sessions
- Organizing study environment
- Coordinating with peers (group study)





Interview participants

- City University students
- School of Science and Technology
- Electrical Engineering and Computer Science



Participants and their data

- Prescreener qualtrics survey
- Informed consent form
- Voluntary participation
- Withdrawal window
- Anonymisation & local data processing
- GDPR compliance (City Uni)





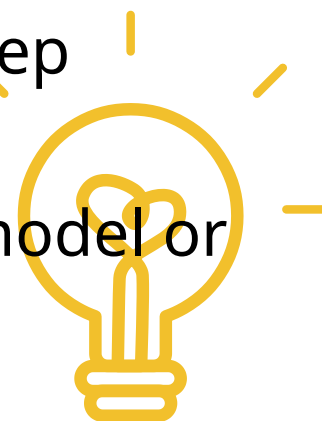
Interview logistics

- Location: Either at Uni, or on Teams (remote)
- Equipment: Laptop (both researcher and participant)
- Audio/Video captured by mobile device in person, or teams screenrecording.
- Time: Approx. 20 mins.



Data (collection!)

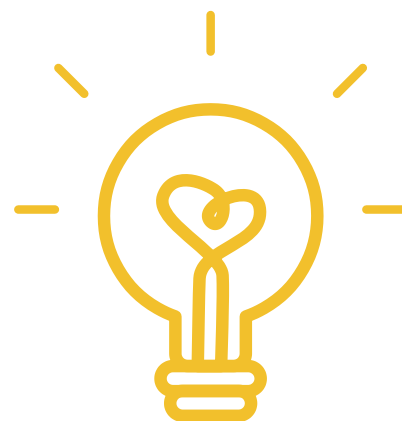
- Audio/Video recording of interview
- Screen capture of walkthrough
- Researcher's notes (small ones to keep context)
- Transcript of recording (local voice model or teams' transcription)





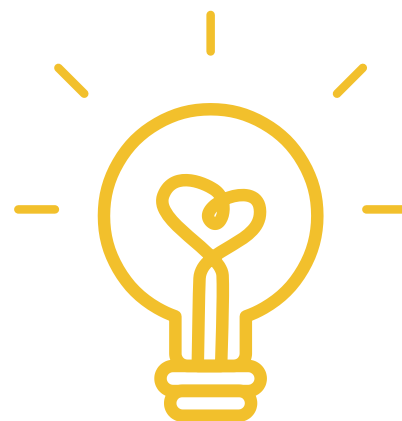
Interview Guide

- Understand students' planning, environments, tools, and pain points.
- Semi-structured.



Interview Guide Deep Dive!

- 3 main topics
- Planning their study time
- Setting up study environment
- Study habits and Practices





Walkthrough(s)

- One walkthrough
- Focus on how participants interact with their currently available study tools and materials
- Participant will either share screen or show me in person.
- Focus on materials, setup, tools.



Walkthrough (continued)

- Looking for friction, workarounds, tool (context) switching
- Things that may not be obvious to the participant but appear when actually using the tools.





Data Analysis

- Transcripts will feed into thematic analysis
- Affinity mapping (to identify pain points and bright spots)
- Create a persona aggregating the traits of the participants



Data Analysis cont.

- A user journey map derived from all the walkthroughs
- Detail how students currently study (highlight high friction areas)



Thank you!

Picture source: <https://www.citystgeorges.ac.uk/prospective-students/student-life>

2 Research Materials

The main goal when creating these interviews is to understand the existing study flow occurring for the average student. I'd like to target students (particularly those who are preparing for exams and studying across the year). Flow will be prescreening questionnaire, if they have the right profile (will capture emails), send information sheet. Will schedule a time for the actual interview, then complete the informed consent form during the interview, where they can ask questions. After this, I'll follow my interview script, with deviation depending on their answers (semi-structured).

2.1 Prescreening Questionnaire

Studybuddy Prescreening Qualtrics Template

Q1: What year of study are you in?

- Y1
- Y2
- Y3
- Y4
- PG

Q2: Do you regularly study or revise for your modules outside of contact hours? (Lectures/Labs/Tutorials)

- Yes
- No

Q3: Do you use third party tools to support your studies? (This excludes Moodle, Course Textbooks, and Onedrive).

- Yes
- No

Q4: Would you be willing to participate in a 20 minute interview about your study habits?

- Yes
- No

Q5: What is your city email?

{textbox}

2.2 Participant Information Sheet

Participant Information Sheet

Title of Study: IN3065 User-Centred System Design Coursework Project

Name of researcher: Anker Rasmussen (Supervised by Dr Tracey Booth)

Invitation

I would like to invite you to take part in a research study. Before you decide whether you would like to take part, it is important that you understand why the research is being done and what it would involve for you. Please take time to read the following information carefully and discuss it with others if you wish. Please ask me if there is anything that is not clear or if you would like more information. You can keep a copy of this document.

What is the purpose of the study?

The study is for a coursework project that I am carrying out as part of a taught module, *IN3065/INM355 User-Centred System Design*, on the BSc Computer Science programme, at City St George's, University of London.

The purpose of this study is to gather information that will be used to inform the design, by me, of a new system that meets a specific brief I have been given. The aim of this new system is to help students study more effectively across a range of fields including timetabling and coordinating with peers. As part of this project, I am conducting user research with people who undertake the types of activities that the new system will facilitate, and/or who are potential users of this new system. This user research is a crucial part of my design project, and your input will be very valuable.

The research and design activities I undertake will be written up as a report, that I will submit to City St George's, University of London, for assessment, to determine my final grade for the module.

Why have I been invited?

You have been invited to take part in this study because

- you are a prospective user of the system I will be designing, and/or you undertake the types of activities it will facilitate
- you are an adult, aged at least 18 years old.
- you do not consider yourself to be vulnerable.
- you regularly spend time outside of university timetabled hours studying for your courses/modules.

Do I have to take part?

Participation in the project is voluntary. It is up to you to decide whether or not to take part, and you can choose not to participate in part or all of the project; this includes choosing not to answer any questions which you feel are too personal or intrusive, or undertake specific tasks. If you decide to take part, you will be asked to sign an Informed Consent form before

any data is collected. If you decide to take part, you are still free to withdraw at any stage within 14 days of completing the interview, without giving a reason, and without being penalised or disadvantaged in any way. Once data has been anonymised (14 days), participants will no longer be able to withdraw their data.

What will happen if I take part? What will I have to do?

This session will take place either in person or remotely, depending on timetabling for both the participant and researcher, with remote being a recorded microsoft teams call.

You will take part in a semi-structured interview which is going to last approximately 20 minutes.

This interview will entail answering verbal questions about your study habits, difficulties, environment, and tools used.

You will be asked to share your screen and walk through a typical study session while being observed.

The session will be audio and video recorded, and transcribed locally on the researcher's device. All transcripts will be anonymized.

You will only need to meet with the researcher once, to complete the interview. No follow up is necessary.

What are the possible disadvantages and risks of taking part?

There are no foreseeable risks or harms or possible side effects for participating in this study.

What are the possible benefits of taking part?

There are no specific benefits of taking part, but I hope you enjoy the experience of participating in the study.

Expenses and Payments

You will not be paid or have expenses compensated for taking part, but I am very grateful for your help.

What should I do if I want to take part?

Once you have read this participant information sheet in full and are confident that you understand what participating in the study would involve, if you decide that you are willing to take part, please send me an email at anker.rasmussen@citystgeorges.ac.uk. If you are reading this, you've already passed the qualtrics survey, so this will be to set up a suitable time between us.

Data privacy statement

City St George's, University of London is the sponsor and the data controller of this study based in the United Kingdom. This means that we are responsible for looking after your

information and using it properly. The legal basis under which your data will be processed is City St George's public task.

Your rights to access, change or move your information are limited, as we need to manage your information in a specific way in order for the research to be reliable and accurate. To safeguard your rights, we will use the minimum personally identifiable information possible (for further information please see <https://ico.org.uk/for-organisations/uk-gdpr-guidance-and-resources/lawful-basis/a-guide-to-lawful-basis/public-task/>).

City St George's will use your name and contact details to contact you about the research study as necessary. The only people at City St George's who will have access to your identifiable information will be the researcher (student), staff responsible for assessing the coursework, and, if appropriate, individuals with responsibility for monitoring and auditing at City St George's. There may be occasions when regulatory authorities may access research data in accordance with their statutory powers. City St George's will keep identifiable information about you from this study for 7 years after the study has finished.

You can find out more about how City St George's handles personal data by visiting <https://www.citystgeorges.ac.uk/about/governance/policies/data-protection-policy>.

You can also read City St George's general privacy notice by visiting <https://www.citystgeorges.ac.uk/about/governance/policies/general-privacy-notice>.

If you are concerned about how we have processed your personal data, you can contact the Information Commissioner's Office (ICO) directly <https://ico.org.uk/>.

Will my taking part in the study be kept confidential?

Only the researcher (me) and any staff responsible for assessing the coursework will have access to your data at any point. The data gathered in this study, including your identity and personal information, will be kept confidential. Data will be anonymised or de-identified where possible, and stored securely in a password protected location, in accordance with the University's data protection regulations. No personally identifiable data will be published; any quotes will be anonymised. The raw data, including any recordings, will be destroyed once the marks for the coursework have been approved by the University's Assessment Board.

What will happen to the results?

The anonymised results of the study will be included in a coursework report for the university module *IN3065 User-Centred System Design*, which will be submitted to the University for marking (assessment). They may also be used in a future portfolio of my work.

Who has reviewed the study?

This coursework project has been approved by a representative of City St George's, University of London Computer Science Research Ethics Committee.

What if there is a problem?

If you have any problems, concerns or questions about this study, you should ask to speak to a member of the research team (see contact details at the bottom of this document).

If you remain unhappy and wish to complain formally, you can do this through City's complaints procedure. To complain about the study, you need to phone 020 7040 3040. You can then ask to speak to the Secretary to Senate Research Ethics Committee and inform them that the name of the project is **IN3065/INM355 User-Centred System Design coursework project**

Research Governance, Ethics, and Integrity Manager
Research & Innovation Directorate
City St George's, University of London
Northampton Square
London, EC1V 0HB
Email: senaterec@city.ac.uk

Insurance

City St George's, University of London holds insurance policies which apply to this study, subject to the terms and conditions of the policy. If you feel you have been harmed or injured by taking part in this study, you may be eligible to claim compensation. This does not affect your legal rights to seek compensation. If you are harmed due to someone's negligence, then you may have grounds for legal action.

Further information and contact details

For further information about this study, please contact one of the following people, as appropriate:

Researcher (student):	Anker Rasmussen	anker.rasmussen@citystgeorges.ac.uk
Module Leader / Lecturer:	Dr Tracey Booth	tracey.booth.2@citystgeorges.ac.uk

Thank you for taking the time to read this information sheet.

2.3 Informed Consent Form Template

Participant Informed Consent Form

Title of Study: IN3065 User-Centred System Design Coursework Project

Please tick
or initial box

1	I confirm that I have read the <i>Participant Information Sheet</i> for this student coursework project, and can keep a copy of that information for my records. The study has been explained to me, and I had opportunity to ask questions, which were answered satisfactorily.	
2	I understand that my participation is voluntary, that I can choose not to participate in part or all of the project, and that I can withdraw at any stage, without penalty or disadvantage.	
3	I understand that I will be able to withdraw my data up to 14 days after the session has taken place (inclusive of the date of the session).	
4	I agree to be asked verbal questions.	
5	I agree to the session being audio and video recorded, inclusive of screen capture.	
6	I agree to undertake my usual study activities on a digital device while being observed.	
7	I agree to the use of anonymised direct quotes from me in the written part of this project.	
8	I understand that anonymised direct quotes from me, de-identified results and screen images, may be reused in future teaching.	
9	I understand that anonymised quotes from me, de-identified results and screen images, may be used in reports, presentations, publications and portfolios of the student's work.	
10	I understand that no information that could lead to the identification of any individual will be shared with any other party other than the researcher (student) and those involved in assessing the coursework.	
11	I agree to City St George's recording and processing this information about me. I understand that this information will be used only for the purpose(s) explained in the <i>Participant Information Sheet</i> , and my consent is conditional on City complying with its duties and obligations under the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR).	
12	I understand that data from this study will be stored securely on a password-protected device, and deleted/destroyed after the coursework marks have been approved by the Assessment Board.	
13	I agree to take part in this study.	



City St George's, University of London
Northampton Square
London, EC1V 0HB
United Kingdom
+44 (0)20 7040 5060

Name of Participant

Signature

Date

Contact details

Name of Researcher

Signature

Date

Contact details

2.4 Interview Guide/Script

This is a semi-structured interview with the goal of evolving and adapting with the interviewee's experiences to get the richest content. Big overarching topics to try to get content related from each interview.

Interview Goals

Figure out how students are currently studying with regard to their current modules, exams, quizzes, and extracurriculars. Understand exactly how they study, if it differs between different types of modules. Understand current flows, what are critically missing from existing solutions, what they wish they could have, friction, and things other solutions do well. I'd also like to understand the environment normally studied in (home, library, with friends, third spaces).

Topic Headings

1. Planning study time.
2. Study environment.
3. Study session itself.

Introduction Script

Hi, good {time of day}, as I'm sure you read in the brief, you know I'm here to interview you. This should take roughly 20 minutes, depending on how much we have to talk to one another, but don't worry about overrunning. It's better to talk too much than too little. I'm gonna be doing some requirements gathering about a new application that will help you study (hopefully). You've signed the consent form but it's entirely ok if there's a question that I ask that you choose not to answer, and I will be recording this, which you can also request to have deleted/not have yourself participate in this. I'm also going to be taking simple notes that help me maintain context through this interview, but this will also be transcribed (so I don't have to type everything!) So! Now that I've completed this formality, we can get started.

Warmup Questions

- We're gonna start easy, what modules do you have this semester? (notes for this for callbacks!)
 - How would you rank them in difficulty?
 - What do you do in {most-least difficult} modules? (note: looking for type of work done, maths heavy, physics heavy, essay heavy, maybe just a lot of reading?)
- Is moodle integral to your study materials/planning? (notes for this for callbacks!)

Primary Questions

Topic 1: Planning the study time

- Do you structure your day for studying? (easy follow ups)
 - If yes:

- * How do you prioritize your modules?
- * Followup: Do you give more time to difficult modules?
- * Followup: A different strategy per module?
- **If no:**
 - * Why not?
 - * followup: Do you want to make your day more structured? (think calendar telling you study {callback to module} for xyz minutes).
- Do you have your study materials easily accessible when you study? (use Moodle as lynchpin to drive further questions)
 - **If yes:**
 - * Do you have a sorted system when it comes to studying?
 - * How do you arrange your study materials?
 - **If no:**
 - * How do you feel about Moodle's offerings when it comes to structuring study material?
 - * Do you collate the material on your local disk? (ssd/hdd.)
- Do you use any applications/webapps to help you study? (examples: Notion, quizlet, anki, etc..)
 - How effective are these tools?

Intermezzo topic switch:

So! We've discussed a little about your structure *for* studying, but now we're gonna talk about the environment.

Topic 2: Study environment

- In your opinion, what makes a good (or bad!) study space?
 - Let's dig into it, why?
- Where do you do most of your studies? (notes for this for callbacks!)
 - Do you find yourself more productive in one place?
 - What are the most important things in this space? (silence, lack of distraction, ease of access to technology...?)
 - {If not in a public space (i.e. at home)} How do you guarantee these things?
- When wanting to study, is it difficult to get everything set up?
 - **If yes:**
 - * Let's dig into it! What troubles specifically do you have?
 - **If no:**
 - * Must be organized! Do you have a "ritual" to get the study environment into a conducive environment?

- Would you say you get distracted often in {place}?
 - Is there something you do to remedy this? (noise cancelling earphones, moving, studying at weird hours)

Intermezzo topic switch #2:

Let's get to the final section; your actual study session!

Topic 3: The actual study session

- When you do your studies, do you work alone or with others? (many different routes; alone, others, mixed)
 - Let's talk a little about your preferred way to study. What advantages does {preferred way} have over others?
 - How often do you get to study in an ideal environment? <-followups strongly recommended!
- Do you prefer to snack while doing studies?
 - Does this factor into your location choice whatsoever?
 - Has this ever negatively impacted your studies?
- (note: only if they do group studies) When you study with others, how do you coordinate?
- How do you track what you did in the session?

Walkthrough / Observation

- Let's walk through a typical study session! You'll be doing this on your device, so if you wouldn't mind sharing your screen.
 - Lay the scene out for me.
 - How did you decide where to study?
 - How did you decide when to set up your study time?
 - Probe: what factors influenced this?
 - What topic did you choose to study?
 - Probe: Why this one? (callback: Maybe one of the tougher topics)
 - Did you study in a group this session?
 - Probe: If yes; how did you coordinate? If no, why not?
 - What study tools did you use (examples: moodle, quizlet etc..)
 - Probe: Why did you use tool {a,b,c}?
 - Probe: Tools used, difficulties, interruptions, snacks, successful vs unsuccessful in their eyes?
 - Probe: How successful was the session?
 - Followup; how do you gauge session success?

Closing

Thank you for your time and participation. Before we wrap this up, is there anything more you'd like to add that we haven't covered with regard to your study habits?

A GenAI Usage Log

The following table documents all use of Generative AI tools during the preparation of CW1 materials, including prompts/inputs, outputs and uses.

Date	Tool	Prompt/Input	Output & Use
2026-02-18	Claude Opus 4.6 (Claude Code CLI)	Read through brief.pdf, create wireframe .tex, and attribute this prompt and your creation of the wireframe in the appendix of pt1 (cw1).	Generated the initial $\text{\LaTeX}$ document skeleton for CW1 (section structure, package imports including TikZ, cover page, appendix layout, and this GenAI log). Wireframe content will be authored manually.
2026-02-18	Claude Opus 4.6 (Claude Code CLI)	no; don't do wireframes, just create the sections. ill make the wireframes myself (just import the tikz package). [...] pt1 is pt1. create a .bib too (add this prompt to the appendix).	Separated wireframes into standalone wireframe.tex, created references.bib, removed wireframe appendix from pt1.tex, and added this log entry.
2026-02-18	Claude Opus 4.6 (Claude Code CLI)	I have latex workshop. make sure the format is correct (as specified in brief.pdf). (also add this prompt to the appendix).	Revised pt1.tex formatting to match brief requirements (margins, spacing, orphan prevention, longtable for GenAI log, bibintoc for references in ToC, appendix labelling). Added this log entry.
2026-02-18	Claude Opus 4.6 (Claude Code CLI)	add a hook to claude where you have to attribute prompts and usage in the appendix for this repo. (also add this prompt to the appendix haha).	Created CLAUDE.md in the repo root with a standing instruction to always log GenAI usage to the appendix of the relevant coursework .tex file. Added this log entry.

Date	Tool	Prompt/Input	Output & Use
2026-03-02	Claude Opus 4.6 (Claude Code CLI)	Can you make me a quick LaTeX template based on my tutorial template for me to fill out in the part-1 then document the AI usage in the appendix?	Generated a blank interview guide template in the Interview Guide/Script subsection of pt1.tex, structured after the tutorial 3 handout format (goals, topic headings, intro script, warmup, primary questions with branching follow-ups, walkthrough/observation section, closing). All question content left blank for the student to fill in. Added this log entry.
2026-03-07	Claude Opus 4.6 (Claude Code CLI)	Hey, put in the .pdfs where they should be within the .tex file so I can submit it.	Added pdfpages package and \includepdf commands to embed Presentation.pdf (2-up per page in the Slide Deck section), Participant Information Sheet PDF, and Informed Consent Form PDF into their respective sections of pt1.tex. Added this log entry.
2026-03-07	Claude Opus 4.6 (Claude Code CLI)	Do one pass over my .tex, fix typos and grammatical errors.	Fixed 6 typos/grammar issues: "regards to.their" → "regard to their", "requirement gathering" → "requirements gathering", missing space after colon in Topic 2 heading, missing closing quote on "ritual", "envrionment" → "environment", "Intemerzso" → "Intermezzo", "unsuccessful" → "unsuccessful". Added this log entry.

Date	Tool	Prompt/Input	Output & Use
2026-03-07	Claude Opus 4.6 (Claude Code CLI)	Oh. also add my Qualtrics pdf (it's for my prescreening questionnaire).	Added a "Prescreening Questionnaire" subsection to Research Materials with \includepdf embedding Qualtrics.pdf. Added this log entry.